DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION:

This project report documents my work as a Student Digital Ambassador.

I was required to complete a series of tasks that focused on key digital skills such as creating an awareness infographic, building a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practicing email etiquette, and understanding cybercrime.

Each task was assigned to reflect on aspects of digital literacy, helping me connect theoretical knowledge with practical application.

Through this project, I not only learned how to use different digital tools but also understood the importance of safe, ethical, and professional behaviour in the digital space. Overall, this project provides a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and prepares students for academic and professional success.

TASK 1: CREATE A DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

For Task 1, I was asked to create a one-page visual resource to help batchmates understand what Digital Literacy means and why it matters.

I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic using Canva, which I found very convenient due to its user-friendly interface and variety of design templates. My infographic presents a clear and visually engaging overview of digital literacy concepts for students.

It includes sections explaining what digital literacy is, why it is important, how to verify information, safe internet practices, useful digital tools, and the concept of a digital footprint. I focused on keeping the content simple, structured, and easy to understand, so that even beginners can quickly grasp the key ideas.

While designing, I particularly enjoyed arranging the content into visually distinct sections using colors and shapes to make it easier to read. Since I am already familiar with Canva, the process felt smooth and enjoyable instead of challenging.

Instead of facing difficulties, I found it interesting to experiment with layout and design elements to make the infographic both informative and appealing. This task helped me see how effective visual communication can be in raising awareness about important topics like digital literacy.

TASK 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

Task 2 involved setting up a digital portfolio to showcase my work, skills, and achievements as a Student Digital Ambassador.

GitHub - used for storing and managing projects, especially code, and it allows me to document my learning and showcase my work.

LinkedIn - professional networking platform where I can connect with peers and industry professionals, stay updated on opportunities and present my academic and career achievements.

Kaggle - data science and machine learning platform, where users can practice with datasets, practice machine learning concepts, and participate in competitions.

As a first-year Electronics and Communication Engineering student, I plan to use these platforms consistently over the next four years. On GitHub, I aim to upload new projects related to programming, electronics, and embedded systems. On LinkedIn, I aim to maintain a professional profile, share achievements, and build meaningful connections. On Kaggle, I plan to gradually explore data analysis and develop relevant skills.

Overall, these platforms will help me grow academically and professionally while preparing me for future career opportunities.

TASK 3: EXPLORE CODING & COLLABORATIVE PLATFORMS

For Task 3, I explored a range of digital platforms used in education and professional contexts to documenting my activity and reflect their purpose and features.

I used HackerRank and Google Forms to explore coding and collaboration platforms.

On Google Forms, I created a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz”. This platform was simple and user-friendly, which helped me design a structured quiz with different types of questions such as multiple-choice, checkboxes, and short answers. I built a short quiz covering basic aspects of digital literacy.

On HackerRank, I created an account and earned Badge 2 by completing beginner-level coding challenge and earned . This platform helps in improving programming skills and logical thinking through practice problems. It also allows me to track my progress and build confidence in coding.

Overall, these platforms will help me academically by improving my coding skills and enabling me to collaborate effectively with others. Over time, I plan to solve more problems on HackerRank and use Google Forms for surveys, quizzes, and academic projects, improving my technical and communicational abilities.

TASK 4: DRAFT A PROFESSIONAL EMAIL & ETIQETTE GUIDE

Task 4 required me to focus on understanding and applying professional digital communication.

PART- A:

I drafted two formal emails—one requesting an assignment extension and another expressing interest in a summer internship—adhering to proper email structure, tone, and etiquette. This assisted me in understanding the significance of subject lines, language, and content in formal communication.

I compiled a checklist of 12 rules covering:

• Subject line clarity - always specific, never left blank

• Greeting format - formal (Dear Mr/Ms) vs semi-formal (Hi [Name])

• Tone - professional, neutral, and free from slang or emojis

• Structure - opening, body, and closing in logical order

• Attachments - named clearly, referenced in the body

• Reply time - within 24 - 48 hours for professional emails

PART- B:

I created a social media checklist highlighting responsible online behaviour, including key do's and don'ts for students. Through this task, I realized how poor digital communication can lead to misunderstandings or missed opportunities. Learning proper email etiquette and responsible social media usage is essential for maintaining a professional image.

This task enhanced my awareness of how to communicate effectively and responsibly in digital environments, which will be valuable throughout my academic and professional journey.

Overall, both the tasks helped me realise effectiveness of proper communication and awareness which I would use in future to avoid hustles and work smoothly and safely both academically and professionally.

TASK 5: CYBER AWARENESS CASE STUDY & PREVENTION GUIDE

Task 5 required me to investigate a real-world cybercrime case study and produce a write-up alongside a personal prevention checklist.

CASE STUDY: PHISHING

While researching cybercrime, I came across phishing, and was surprised by how common and absolutely convincing these scams actually are. In most of the cases, user receives an email or message or even a call that looks like it's from a trusted source such as a bank, college portal, or even social media platforms like Instagram or Gmail. These messages aim to create panic scenario by saying things like "Your account will be blocked" or "Urgent verification required" or "Unpaid tax due, pay immediately to avoid fine" and make uses pay/ share OTP/PINS instantly and end up getting scammed.

What shocked me the most is that these emails/ messages can look almost identical to real ones, including logos, formatting, and even official-sounding language. Once the user clicks the link and enters their details, their information gets stolen instantly. According to reports, phishing accounts for a major percentage of cybercrimes globally, which shows how widespread it is.

ANALYSIS

This case study says phishing mainly exploits human behaviour rather than technical weaknesses. Attackers use urgency and trust to make users act quickly without verifying the source. The fraud succeeds only when users click on suspicious links or share sensitive information or make payments . It also highlights that students, regular internet users and elder or any user who could be easy target due to lack of awareness. The consequences can include data theft, account hacking, and financial loss.

Overall, it highlights that lack of awareness is the main reason such attacks succeed, leading to data theft or account misuse. Simple precautions can help prevent these risks.

REFLECTION

This task was very informative and increased my awareness about online safety. I realized that phishing messages can look very genuine, making them difficult to identify.

One habit I would change is to always verify emails or links or SMSs before clicking on them and also avoid sharing personal information on unknown websites.

Overall, this task helped me understand the importance of being cautious and responsible while using digital platforms. Its always right to stay precautious rather then learn from the outcome.

CONCLUCION:

In conclusion, this project significantly improved my awareness and understanding of digital literacy. It provided me with valuable knowledge and practical experience in digital literacy and its real-world applications. Through numerous different tasks, I learned how to use digital tools effectively, maintain a professional online presence, and communicate responsibly in the digital environment. I gained awareness about cyber safety, online fraud, and the importance of protecting personal information.

Each task helped me develop important skills such as problem-solving, communication, and critical thinking. Infographic improved my ability to present information visually, while building a digital portfolio enhanced my professional identity. The coding and collaboration tasks improved my technical and teamwork skills and motivated me to practice regularly. The email etiquette and cybercrime sections improved my understanding of responsible digital behaviour.

Overall, this experience has encouraged me to use digital tools more efficiently and responsibly. I believe these skills will continue to benefit me throughout my four years of study and beyond, especially as I prepare for future career opportunities in the field of engineering.

REFERENCES:

• Canva - https://www.canva.com

• HackerRank - https://www.hackerrank.com

• Google Forms - https://forms.google.com

• GitHub - https://github.com

• LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com

• Kaggle - https://www.kaggle.com

• National Cyber Crime Portal (India) - https://cybercrime.gov.in

• Online articles and study materials on digital literacy and cyber safety

• Class notes and course materials provided during the module